

New York can't build universal child care on poverty wages.

The State is expanding child care faster than ever. The providers who make it possible earn less than 96% of New York workers, and they are leaving the field. Our ask: fund the workforce and fund the families in the 2027 budget.

$1.8B

A wage scale for child care workers

Fund the CUNY-PDI / Workforce Collaborative scale (role, credentials, experience; parity with K-12) for every provider, in centers and homes, without raising what families pay or interfering with collective bargaining.

$1.04B

CCAP for every eligible family

$400M statewide plus $640M for New York City in recurring funding, so no eligible family is waitlisted or turned away, and providers get fair, reliable income.

The need

$37,675
median child care educator pay; less than 96% of NY jobs

$6.01
median hourly take-home for NYC home-based providers

57%
of NY programs short-staffed; 16,000+ kids unserved

- Family child care capacity fell **28%** from 2019 to 2024; 60% of census tracts are child care deserts.
- In May 2026, **31 counties and NYC** had stopped enrolling eligible families in CCAP for lack of funds. NYC's waitlist hit ~30,000 children.
- The FY27 budget added $1.2B for CCAP but nothing for wages.

The principles from NYCAT

1. One minimum wage scale for the field, phased in and indexed.
2. Rates based on the true cost of care.
3. A wage supplement now, while the scale phases in.
4. Progressive revenue that sustains it all.

What the wage scale means

PROVIDER	NOW	SCALE
NYC family child care, HS diploma, 21 yrs	$33,280	**$79,184**
NYC teacher, associate degree, 3 yrs	$40,000	**$69,836**
Buffalo family child care, HS diploma, 11 yrs	$33,280	**$53,792**
Rochester center director, BA + credential, 6 yrs	$52,000	**$76,022**

New York can pay for it

The Fiscal Policy Institute shows a progressive package (a small payroll tax, a corporate surcharge, and a 1% NYC tax on income over $1M) raises about **$8B a year**, enough for statewide universal care with providers earning $50,000 to $60,000.

Will you champion these demands? Tell leadership and the Governor you support $1.8B for the wage scale and $1.04B for CCAP in the 2027 budget, and join POP's Child Care Champions.

Sources: Empire State Campaign for Child Care, 2027 Budget Priorities (Oct 2026); Schuyler Center, NYS DOL data (2025); L. Melodia, Center for NYC Affairs, budget testimony (Feb 2026); Day Care Council of NY (Dec 2025); OCFS data; NYS Comptroller (Feb 2025); New York Focus (June 2026); Chalkbeat (Oct 2026); CUNY-PDI wage scale scenarios; Fiscal Policy Institute (Dec 2025).

PROVIDERS ORGANIZED FOR POWER · the action lab · Empire State Campaign for Child Care · UFT · Citizen Action · New York Communities for Change · AQE Alliance for Quality Education · ECE On The Move · Los Deditos · ILR Worker Institute

popny.org/pay
Pay Our Providers is a campaign of Providers Organized for Power (POP).

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